SUPPORTING
EUROPEAN
AVIATION

PRC Data Challenge 2026

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30th Oct 2026

PRC | Performance Review Commission

PRC Data Challenge 2026

Taxi-out prediction

10

European airports

1 year

Training movements from 2025



Website

https://ansperformance.eu/study/data-challenge/dc2026/

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PRC Data Challenge 2026

Challenge focus over the years

- **2024**

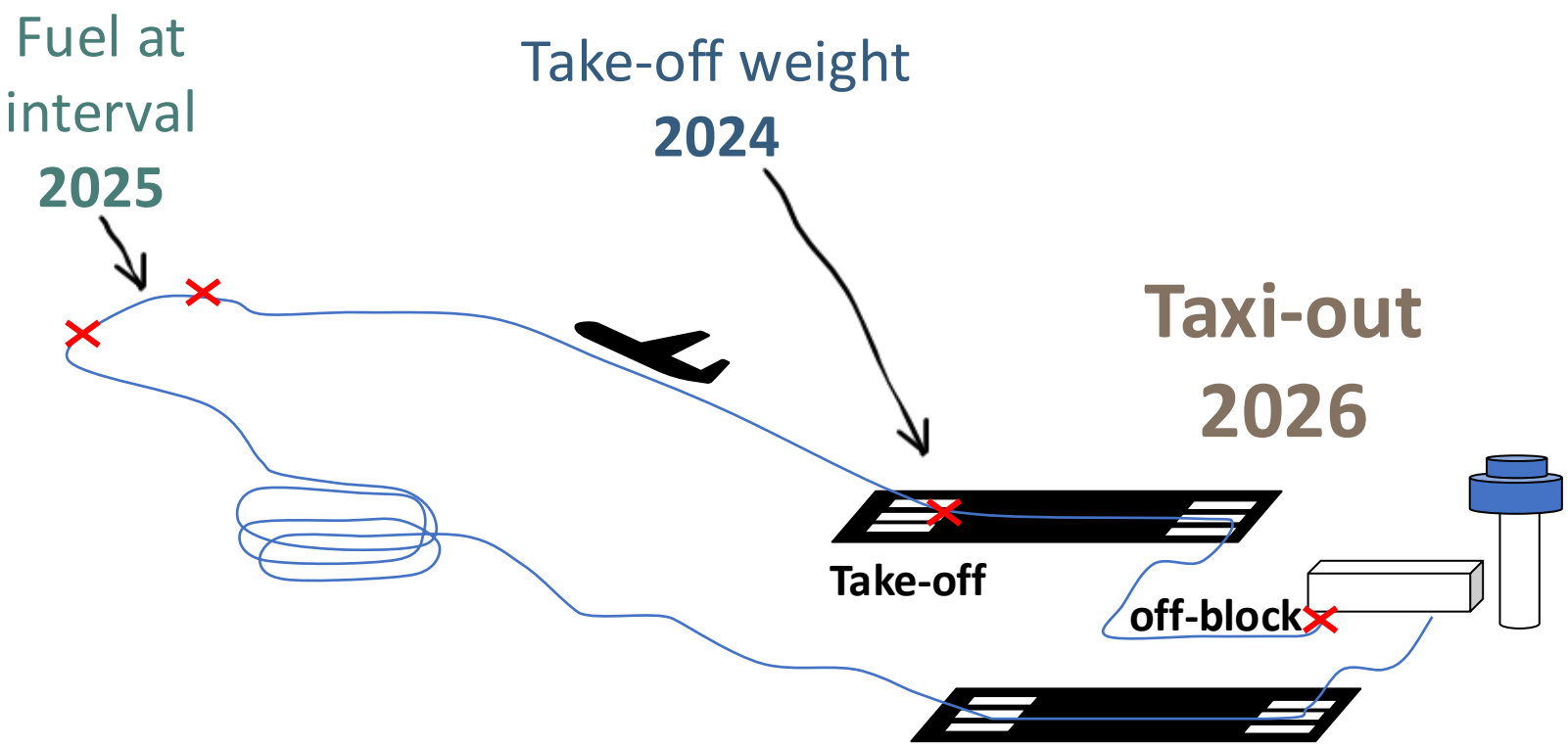
  Take-off weight (TOW)

- **2025**

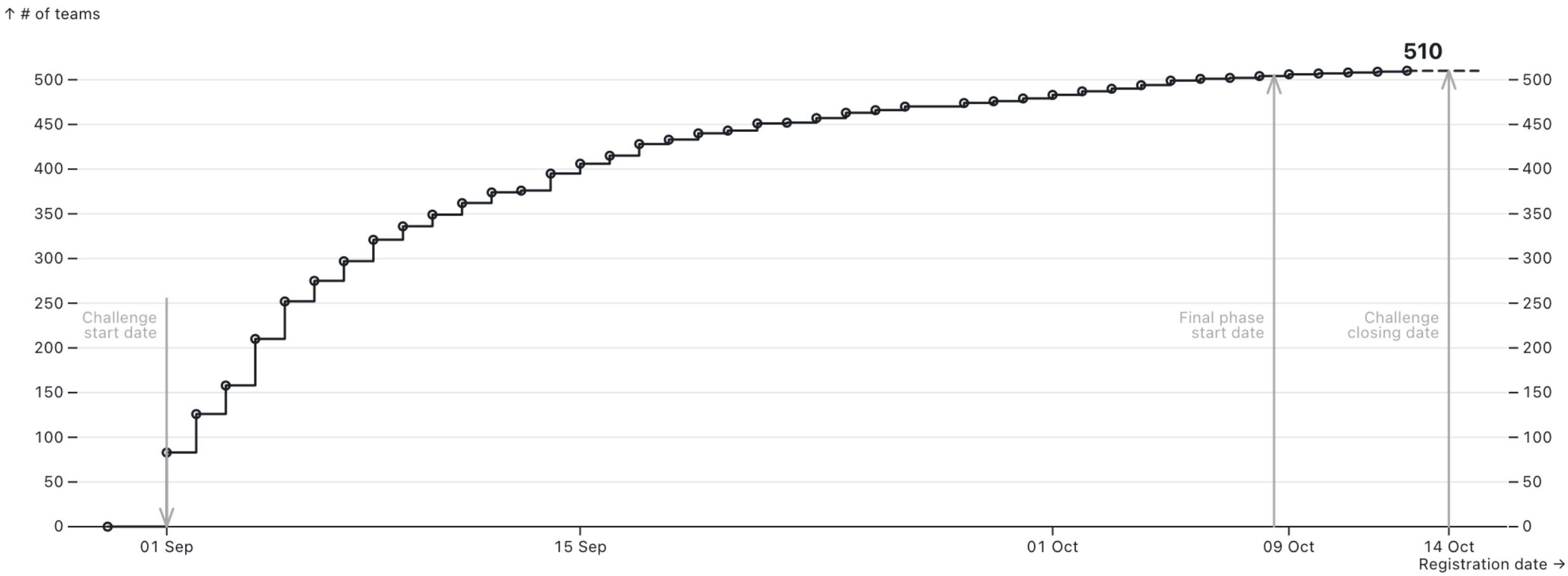
  Fuel at interval

- **2026**

  Taxi-out
  Off-block to take-off



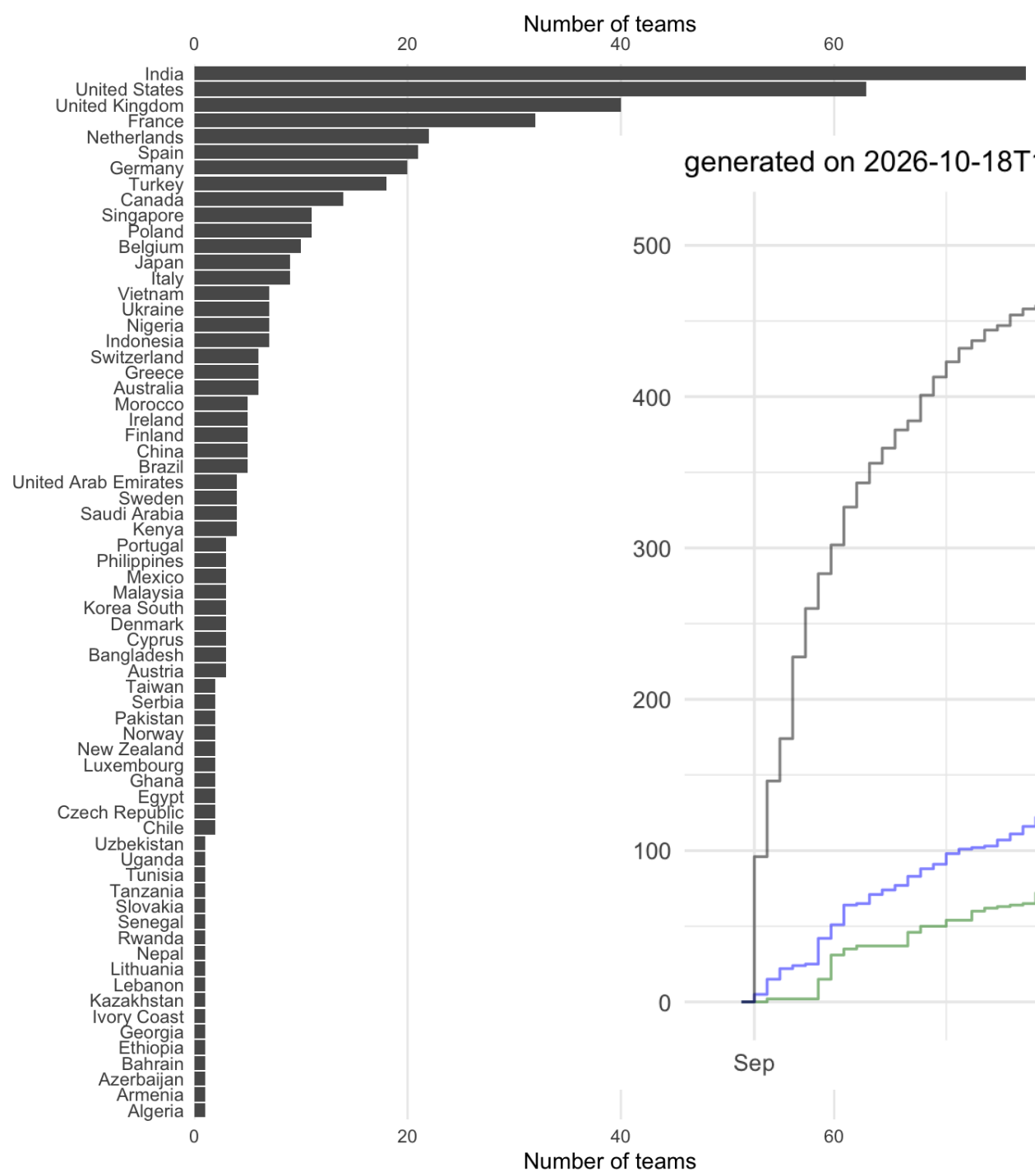
Wide participation 1 of 3

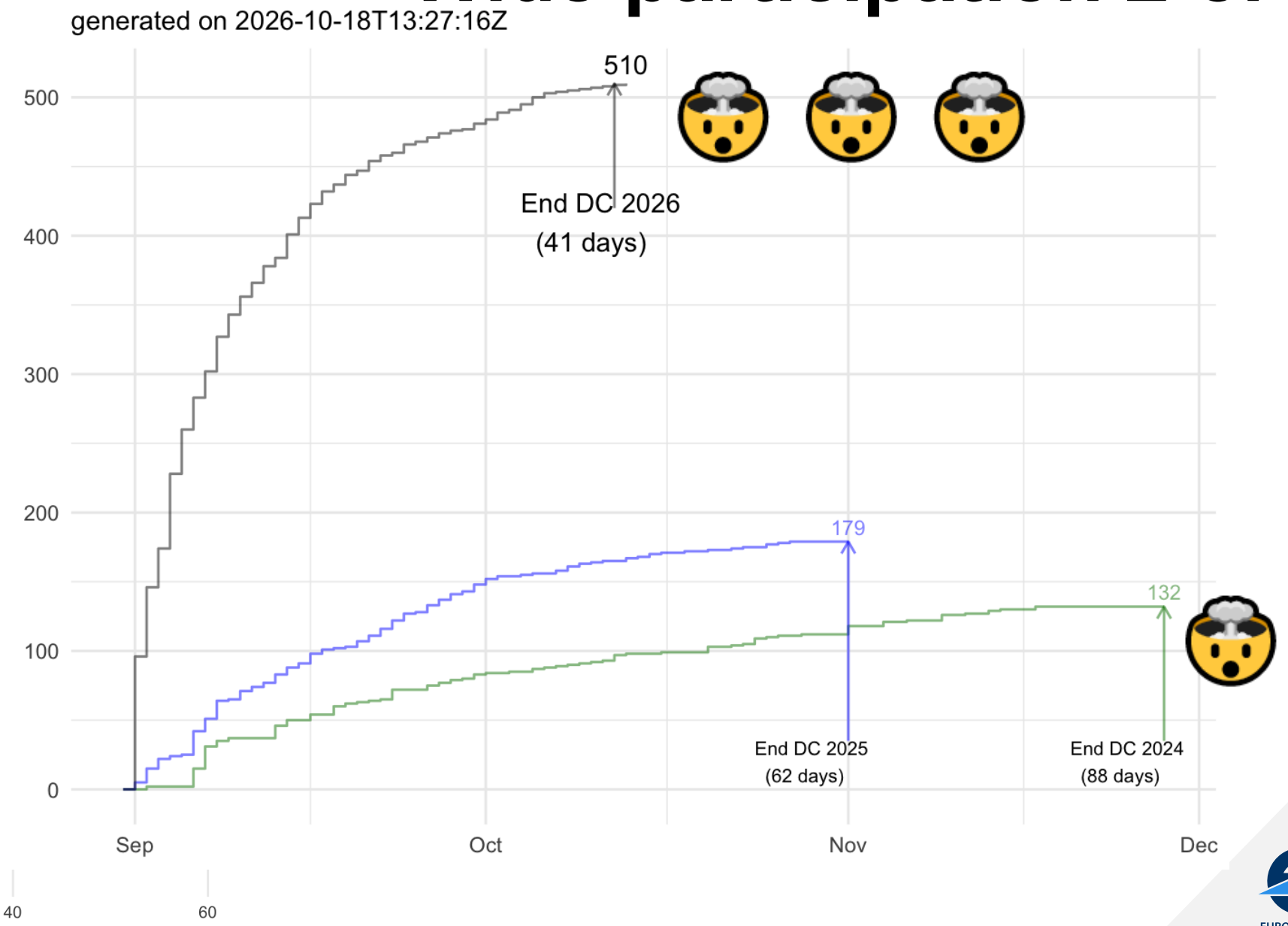


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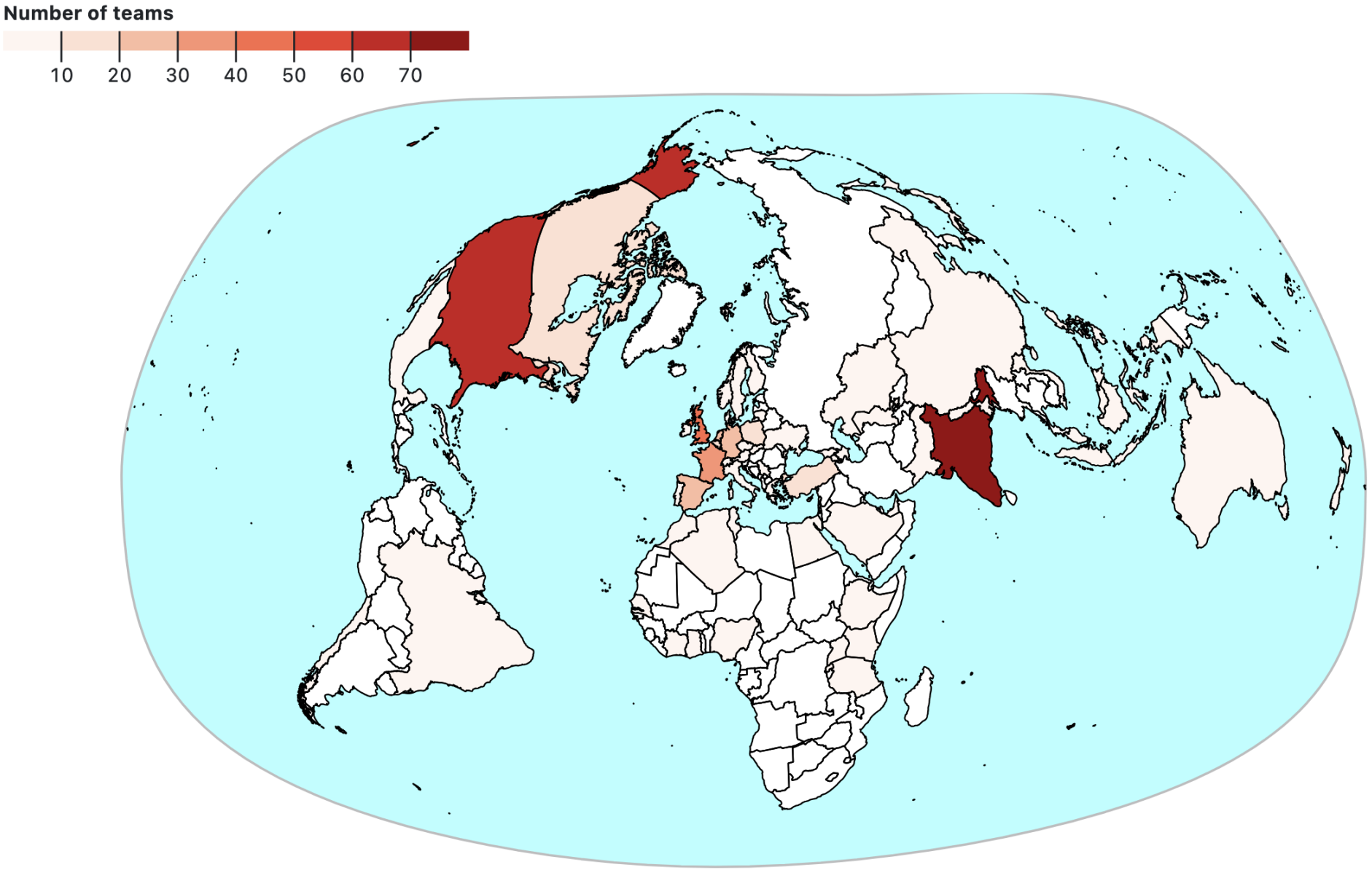
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Wide participation 2 of 3





Wide participation 3 of 3



PRC

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Community

- Nice interactions on Discord or email
- A lot of *patience*
  some people DO NOT read website/discord
- Leaderboard thanks to Arquimedes Canedo

PRC Data Challenge 2026

Best submission per team. Click a column to sort.

Data refreshed 15 minutes ago.

# ▲	Team	Best	Subs	Last activity
1	versatile-watermelon	208.1136	66	13d ago
2	strong-crane	211.7286	92	13d ago
3	unbelievable-snowflake	211.9163	29	13d ago
4	gentle-tractor	212.5167	54	13d ago
5	charming-eel	213.2541	56	13d ago
6	jolly-lobster	213.2898	98	19d ago
7	vigorous-whistle	214.3353	64	19d ago
8	bold-ladder	215.0414	44	15d ago
9	intelligent-guitar	215.7218	15	17d ago
10	strong-moose	217.4849	104	15d ago

The age of AI has come…

- Clearly many teams used **AI agents**
- **Max 5 submissions per day**
- **Combination of models** to squeeze every bit of info out of the data
- **Code quality** questionable
- **Reuse difficult** if not impossible: or just by an AI agent
- **Thorough review humanly impossible** → autograder but limits

World records nobody asked for

11 commits in the same second

funny-firefly, 2 Sep, 10:52:07. 143 commits share a timestamp with their predecessor.

106 commits by one person in one day

Denys Kolomiiets, gentle-igloo, 8 Oct.

A 1,099-character commit subject

vigorous-whistle. Average message there: 274 characters.

The shortest message: "m"

smart-jigsaw, four times. Plus "v5", "265", "idk" and "yeah".

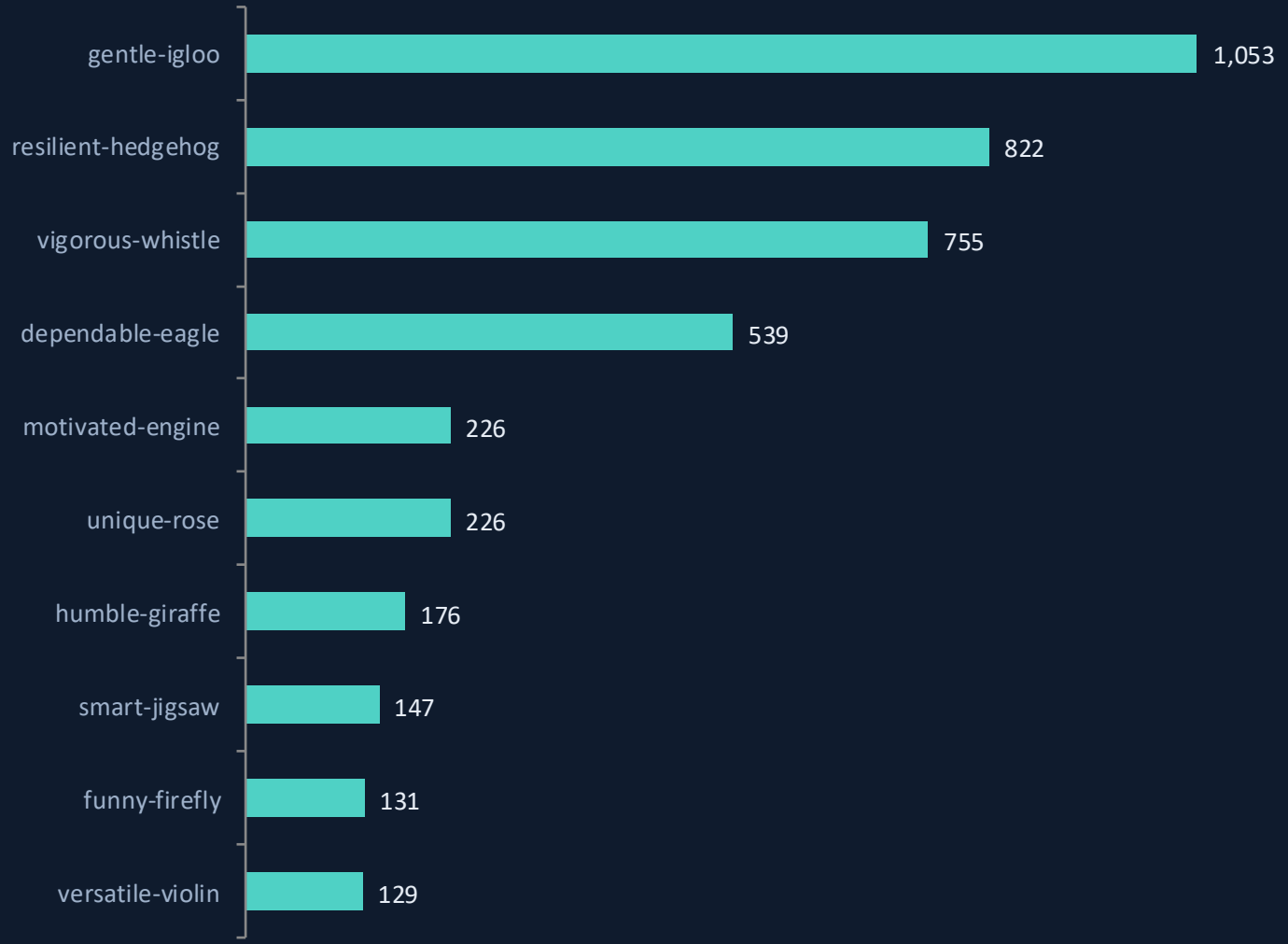
552,740 characters of messages

About the length of The Hobbit, spent explaining commits.

Amendment 358

dependable-eagle ran its repo as a parliament. 368 messages mention an amendment.

The heavy lifters (and the one-hit wonders)



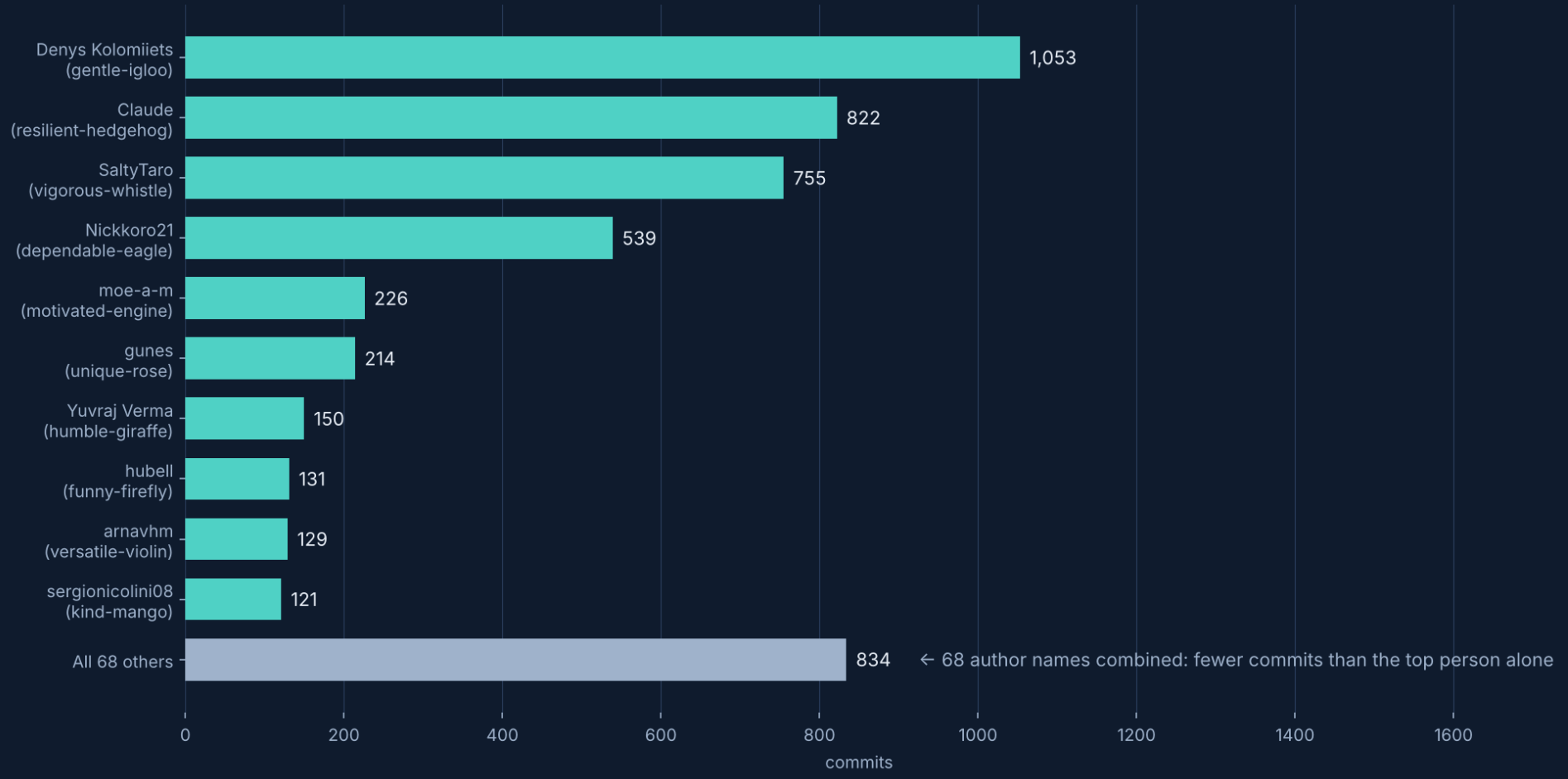
Top 10 repos by commits

gentle-igloo alone made 1,053 commits in 31 days, roughly one every 42 minutes, day and night.

At the other end, 16 repos made exactly one commit. charming-eel's only one is called "god commit".

smart-apple's single commit is authored by "Your Name", the git default nobody changed.

Top 10 committers vs. everybody else



10

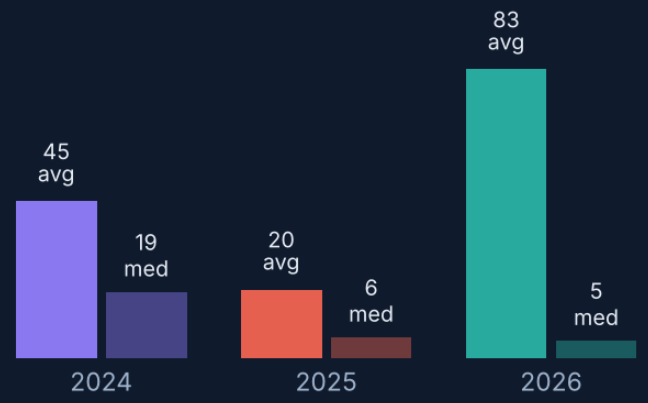
authors made 83% of all commits

#2

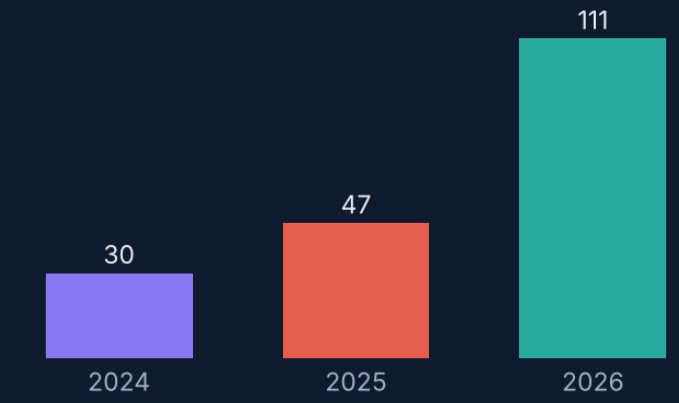
is Claude, credited as author on 822 commits

Same challenge, very different commits

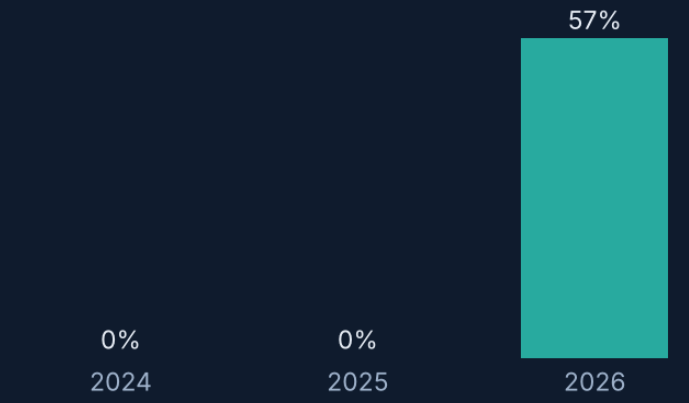
Commits per team: average vs. median



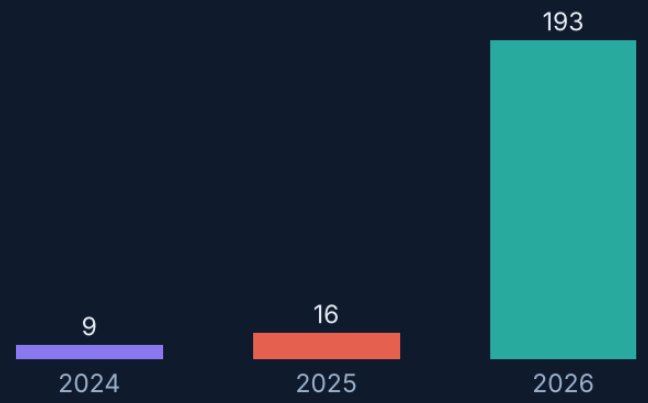
Avg commit message length (chars)



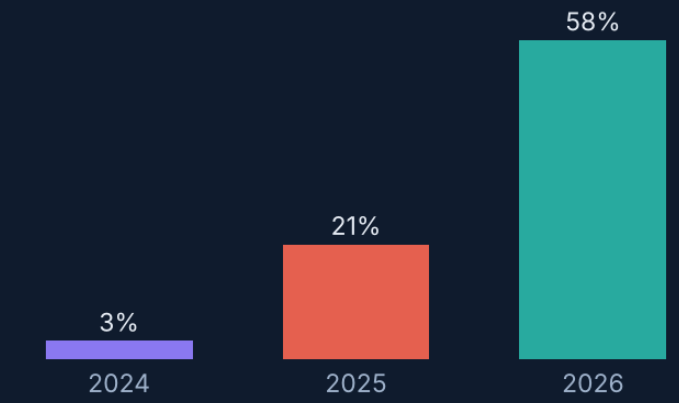
Commits with an AI co-author trailer (%)



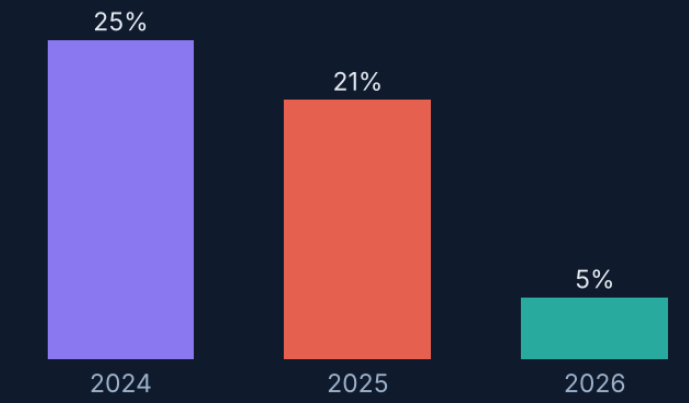
Python files per team (at HEAD)



Teams with a test suite (%)



Commits in the final 24 h (%)



Lesson learnt

- Increase **automation**
  - Only manual action is team creation approval/rejection
  - Rejection should automatically ask for missing info
  - Still insisting on address? (an attempt to stop fake…but can be faked)
- "**Fake**" accounts:
  - Herpa Derpa: old participant from previous editions
  - Joseph Stalin: quite a tense exchange of emails, later on dropped
  - Can we really spot or stop any fake account?
- **Age of AI** is here to stay
  - Guidelines for Agents?
  - Controlled environment?

Thanks (random order)

- **John Fitzgerald**: teams and buckets setup, leaderboard & API
- **Marc Liechti**: support on leaderboard
- **Quinten Goens**: continuous exchange of ideas, autograder et al.
- **Martin Strohmeier**: proxied API, teams creation support
- **Rainer Koelle**: moral support
- **Allan Tart**: tri-weekly meeting and coordination
- **Jose Miguel De Pablo Guerrero**: topic identification and PRC support
- **Christian Eduardo Verdonk Gallego**: topic identification
- "***Friends of OSN***": feedback and encouragement

Finalists

- **61** teams shared repo out of **510 registered** ones
- **96** final submissions (some, just a dump)
- **56** teams eligible, i.e. final submission + repo

~ 11%

Top 10 Finalists

rank	team	country	RMSE
1		USA	176.16
2		Germany	180.18
3		Indonesia	183.66
4	vigorous-whistle	India	183.84
5	gentle-igloo	Portugal	184.03
6	jolly-lobster	USA	185.06
7	strong-moose	Türkiye	186.18
8	strong-crane	India	186.56
9	versatile-watermelon	Netherlands	186.87
10	spirited-tiger	South Korea	188.22

3rd place

- Team: `youthful-giraffe`
- Team members:
  - **Matthew Motoki (Indonesia)** interested in the challenge
- RMSE: 183.66 s

750 EUR

2nd place

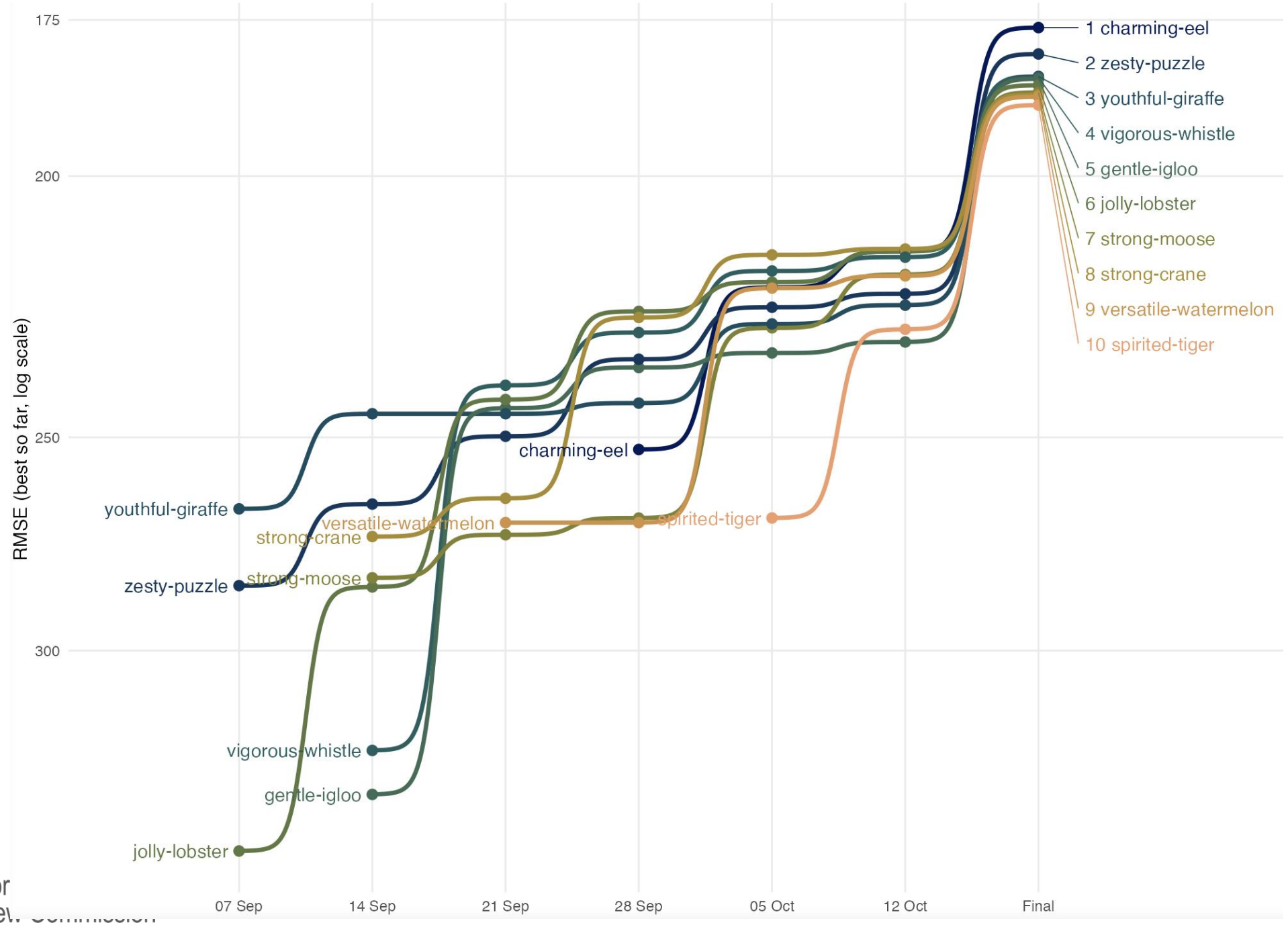
- Team: `zestry-puzzle`
- Team members:
  - **Luis Melzer (Germany)**
    CS student at Leibniz Universität Hannover specializing in machine learning
- RMSE: 180.18 s

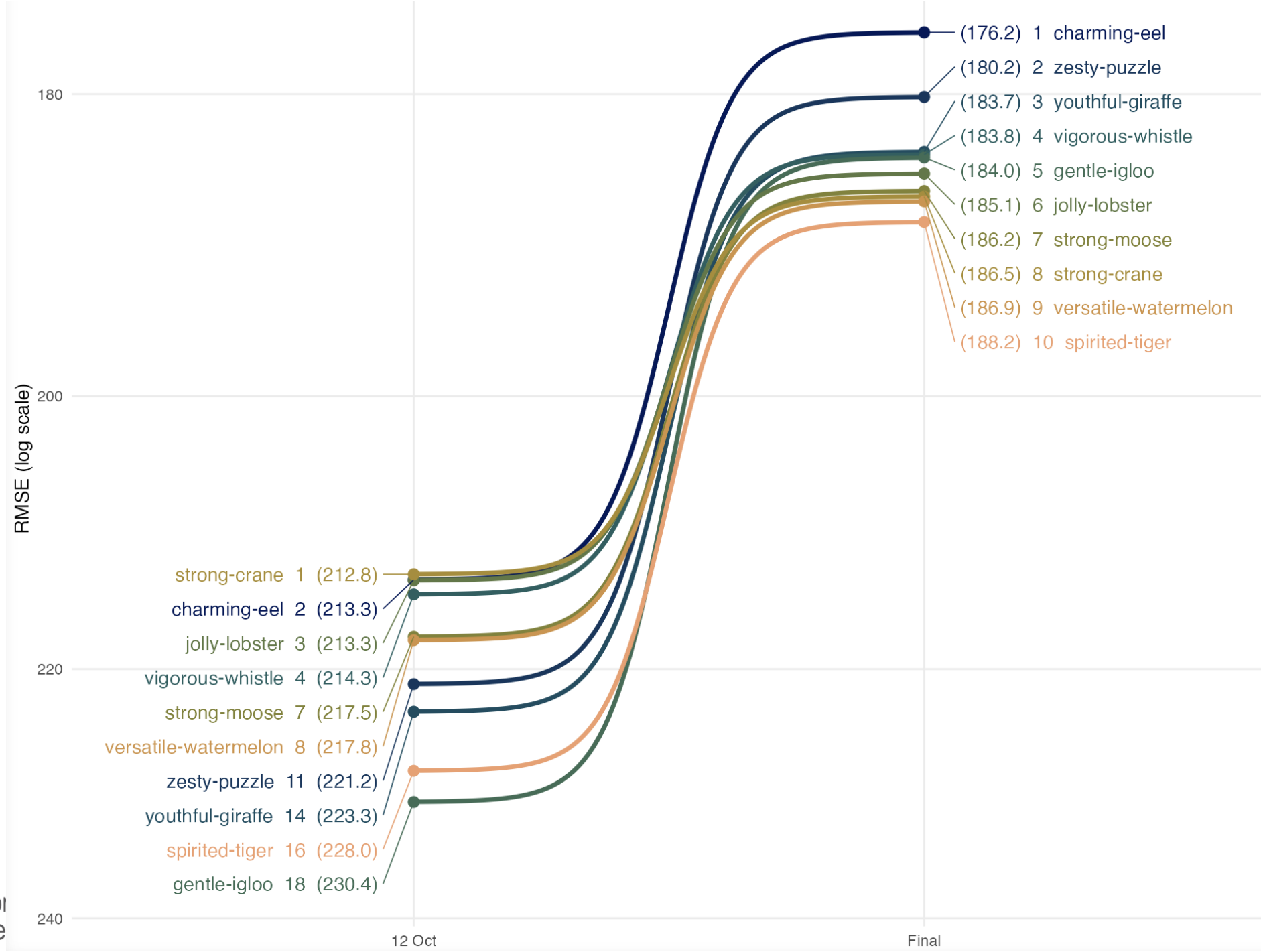
1750 EUR

And the WINNER team is…

- Team: **`charming-eel`**
- Team members:
  - **Aryaman Chawla (USA)**
    AI engineer and ML researcher
- RMSE: 176.16 s

2500 EUR


175
200
250
300
RMSE (best so far, log scale)
07 Sep
14 Sep
21 Sep
28 Sep
05 Oct
12 Oct
Final
1 charming-eel
2 zesty-puzzle
3 youthful-giraffe
4 vigorous-whistle
5 gentle-igloo
6 jolly-lobster
7 strong-moose
8 strong-crane
9 versatile-watermelon
10 spirited-tiger
charming-eel
youthful-giraffe
versatile-watermelon
spirited-tiger
strong-crane
zesty-puzzle
strong-moose
vigorous-whistle
gentle-igloo
jolly-lobster


RMSE (log scale)
180
200
220
240
12 Oct
Final
(176.2) 1 charming-eel
(180.2) 2 zesty-puzzle
(183.7) 3 youthful-giraffe
(183.8) 4 vigorous-whistle
(184.0) 5 gentle-igloo
(185.1) 6 jolly-lobster
(186.2) 7 strong-moose
(186.5) 8 strong-crane
(186.9) 9 versatile-watermelon
(188.2) 10 spirited-tiger
strong-crane 1 (212.8)
charming-eel 2 (213.3)
jolly-lobster 3 (213.3)
vigorous-whistle 4 (214.3)
strong-moose 7 (217.5)
versatile-watermelon 8 (217.8)
zesty-puzzle 11 (221.2)
youthful-giraffe 14 (223.3)
spirited-tiger 16 (228.0)
gentle-igloo 18 (230.4)

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Thank you!



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